

HISTORY HACK • DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Read the following three primary source excerpts and answer the prompt below.

US.37 — Examine challenges and advancements related to the push for civil liberties, including (T.C.A. § 49-6- 1006): • First Red Scare • Immigration Quota Acts of the 1920s • Resurgence of the Ku Klux Klan • Black Wallstreet and Tulsa Massacre • Rise of the NAACP • Efforts of Ida B. Wells-Barnett • Emergence of Garveyism

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

The sources

Document A

Warren G. Harding, "Return to Normalcy" campaign speech, Boston, Massachusetts, May 14, 1920 (Congressional Record, public domain)

“America's present need is not heroics but healing; not nostrums but normalcy; not revolution but restoration; not agitation but adjustment; not surgery but serenity; not the dramatic but the dispassionate; not experiment but equipoise; not submergence in internationality but sustainment in triumphant nationality.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT A

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document B

A. Mitchell Palmer, "The Case Against the Reds," Records of the Department of Justice, National Archives (archives.gov), February 1920 (National Archives, Record Group 60 (archives.gov), public domain)

“The Department of Justice will pursue...not only those persons who commit overt acts against the Government, but also those who advocate the overthrow of our institutions by force or violence... The Red movement has its headquarters in this country, is financed by the alien enemy, and its purpose is to spread its communistic propaganda by any and every means.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT B

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

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Document C

Immigration Act of 1924 (Johnson-Reed Act), Congressional findings, 68th Congress (U.S. Statutes at Large, public domain)

“It is the sense of the Congress that the racial composition of the American people should be maintained; and the President is authorized and requested to make representations accordingly to foreign governments.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT C

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

Using ALL THREE documents and your knowledge of the Red Scare (US.28), immigration restriction (US.29), and the political ideology of 'normalcy' (US.35), write a multi-paragraph response that applies HIPP to each document and constructs an argument about how the concept of 'Americanism' functioned as a political ideology in the early 1920s. Your response

1. apply HIPP to all three documents
2. identify what each document defines as a threat to 'America'
3. construct a supported argument about how these three documents together reveal a coherent but exclusionary definition of 'American.'

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document A		
Document B		
Document C		
Outside knowledge		

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Full HIPP for all three documents. Constructs a precise argument about 'Americanism' as exclusionary ideology. Identifies the specific 'threat' each document names. Synthesizes all three into a unified argument. At least two pieces of outside evidence.
5	Advanced. HIPP (3+ elements) for all three. Clear unified argument. All three documents cited. At least one piece of outside evidence.
4	Proficient. HIPP (2+ elements) for at least two documents. Argument present. At least two documents used.
3	Adequate. Some HIPP for two or more. Argument underdeveloped.
2	Developing. HIPP for only one document. Weak argument.
1	Beginning. Summary without HIPP. No clear argument.
0	No response or completely off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: Each document's 'threat' must be explicitly named; Document C's 'racial composition' language must be analyzed for its eugenic assumptions. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Palmer Raids, Emergency Quota Act, KKK revival, eugenics movement, ACLU founding, anti-lynching bill failures.

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.